

A-Z GUIDE to longevity

A little thought to what we eat and a few small changes in lifestyle can make a huge difference to our well-being

A **ASPIRIN**

For years, it was just a humble painkiller. Now it's hailed as a 'wondercure' for anything—from fever, heart diseases to cancer. It may not have the sex appeal of newer drugs, but it's effective, cheap and relatively safe. Should one pop in a pill every day? Wait. The medical jury is still out on its long term effectiveness.

G **GINGER**

Researchers believe, this humble root has antioxidant properties which help prevent cancer, diabetes and heart attacks. It also works as an anti-inflammatory agent to treat arthritis. Perfect excuse for scoffing that packet of ginger biscuits.

BERRIES

These little fruits are superheroes. A diet rich in berries—from amla to kalajamun— help the aging brain stay sharp. Chock-full of antioxidants and low on sugar, they boost levels of the 'good cholesterol', HDL. They also play a role in preventing cancer and heart diseases.



H **HERBAL TEA**

When not drinking boiled water with a slice of lemon, the herbal tea brigade sips ginger and cinnamon tea for boosting the immune system, chamomile tea for relaxing before bedtime and mint tea for easing digestive disorders. A healthy, style statement.



C **CHOCOLATE**

Besides tasting great, it can lift your mood by releasing endorphins (the body's natural painkillers) into the brain. New research says, it is rich in flavonoids, that raise good cholesterol levels. Overdo it though and depression will return when your weight soars and your skin comes out in spots.



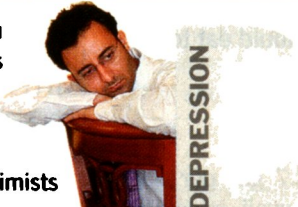
I **INSULIN**

Hungry all the time? Think insulin, the hormone that your pancreas produces. As blood sugar increases after a carb-rich meal, insulin also rises—to lower blood sugar. This leads to craving for food, often hours after a meal. Limit refined sugars and carbs to about 40 per cent of your diet.



D **DEPRESSION**

Depression is the biggest health threat after heart diseases, says the World Health Organisation. Doctors link calorie-rich 'modern' diets with higher risks of depression. Pessimists have something to worry about.



J **JUICING**

Juicing fruits and veggies is all the rage. Fans attribute all manner of health-enhancing qualities—detoxification and weight-loss. The main advantage of juicing is that pulverised raw materials can taste good and may encourage you to consume more fruit and vegetables. If you hate to eat your greens, drink up.



E **EGGS**

Once considered a cholesterol-laden no-no, eggs are making a comeback. They are loaded with vitamins, minerals, proteins and choline (for effective nerve-muscle communication). Your best bet is to keep it simple: one hard-boiled egg a day.



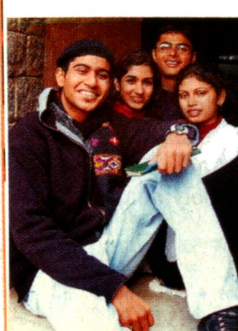
K **VITAMIN**

Little appreciated. Most multi-vitamins don't contain any. But now, medics say, it's great for building bones and promoting a healthy heart. Vitamin K is found in a whole range of foods— green leafy vegetables and the commonly used cooking oils.



F **FRIENDS**

Research shows, the number of people we count as our closest friends has shrunk in the last 20 years world over. Any health consequence? Robust social networks lower blood pressure, say medics. Make friends, have fun.



L **LAUGHTER**

May not be the best medicine, but it certainly boosts health. Laughter stimulates movement of blood to the heart and lungs. It also enhances antibodies that help fight sickness and release stress-fighting hormones. Watching a funny film is like a jolt of aerobic exercise.

